Modelantwoord: huiswerk argumentatiestructuur week 1

Hoofdstelling

“Algorithmic decision-making in high-stakes domains requires democratic oversight, transparent criteria, and the right to human review — it cannot be left to technology companies to regulate themselves.”

De hele tekst werkt naar deze stelling toe. Expliciet gegeven in de laatste alinea.

Ondersteunende argumentatie

Twee hoofdargumenten voor deze stelling

Argument 1: Algorithmen reproduceren historische bias

- **Reason:** Algorithms are trained on historical data, which may reflect past discrimination
- **Evidence:** Example of neighbourhoods historically denied loans — an algorithm trained on this data will replicate and amplify the discriminatory pattern
- **Intermediate conclusion:** Algorithms are not neutral; they encode the biases of the world that produced them

Argument 2: Optimisation criteria embed value judgments

- **Reason:** Choosing what an algorithm should optimise for is not a technical decision but a normative one
- **Evidence:** Example of a hiring algorithm instructed to find candidates "similar to our best performers" — this assumes past success is the right model, potentially excluding capable candidates who don't fit the historical profile
- **Intermediate conclusion:** Even "improved" data cannot solve the problem, because the framing of the optimisation goal is itself contestable

Tegenwerpingen

Er worden twee tegenwerpingen besproken en weerlegd.

Tegenwerping 1	Algorithms are more objective than humans because they apply criteria consistently and are free from personal bias

Weerlegging	Consistency is not the same as fairness; if the underlying data is biased, consistent application of it produces consistently biased outcomes
Tegenwerping 2	Even if we accept the bias problem, the solution is simply to improve the data
Weerlegging	Improving data does not resolve the deeper issue: the choice of what to optimise for is itself a value judgment that cannot be made purely technically